



MODEL 1934



MODEL S-686, 1982

1526 Mastro Bartolomeo Beretta supplies 185 harquebus barrels to the arsenal in Venice.

1915 Beretta begins to produce semiautomatic pistols—a type of gun that will become one of its most important products during the 20th century.

1918 Beretta's first submachine-gun, the Model 1918, is launched and taken up by the Italian Army.

1934 The Model 1934, a compact, semiautomatic pistol designed for the Italian Army, is created.

1935 The SO series of over-and-under shotguns is launched, beginning an enduring line of double-barreled shotguns, including the Model S-686, that lasts until today.

1953 In Ian Fleming's first James Bond novel, *Casino Royale*, the hero carries a Beretta 418 pistol.

1985 The semiautomatic M9 is ordered for the US Army as a replacement for the venerable M1911 pistol designed by John Browning.



“We are **Beretta**. We don't want to make a copy of other shapes.”

ATTRIBUTED TO **FRANCO BERETTA**,
SON OF **UGO GUSSALLI BERETTA**

◀ TARGET SHOOTING

Beretta weapons have found particular favor with competitive skeet shooters. Here, Australian shooter George Barton fires a Beretta during an event in Melbourne in 2006.

1904 until his death in 1965. Marengoni's work in small arms bore fruit in the form of the Model 34, which sold in huge numbers over a 40-year period. This tradition has continued with the M9, issued to the US Army, and the 92 series, bought widely by armed forces around the world. These weapons are valued for their precision of manufacture and reliability, as are Beretta's competition rifles and shotguns, especially the SO (*Sovrapposto*, indicating that the barrels are arranged one above the other) shotgun series launched in 1935. The firm's position in this area was also strengthened by the fact that Pietro Beretta's nephew, Carlo, was an avid competition marksman, giving the designers informed feedback on the firearms he used.

FOR THE ATHLETES

By 1956, the excellence of the weapons was confirmed at the Melbourne Olympics, at which a shooting competitor with a Beretta won gold for the first time; medals went to Beretta shooters in nearly all the following Olympics, and there were also successes in the World Championships from 1978 onward. The success enjoyed by the SO1 has continued to today, with the SO5 and the SO6—premium firearms that combine excellent balance and precision with beautiful design. In addition to these premium weapons, Beretta also produces many competition and hunting weapons designed for users on a budget that still maintain the quality and reliability that have made the company's name.